ASSIGNMENT NO.4

INSTRUCTOR: LÊ HOÀNG ANH

CLASS: MKT1903

COURSE: EXE101

GROUP: 3

NUMBER	NAME	ID STUDENT
1	NGUYỄN THỊ HẢI YẾN	HS170194
2	BÙI THỊ THÙY DƯƠNG	HS180238
3	TĂNG LAN ANH	HS180573
4	PHẠM THẾ SƠN	HE181997
5	NGUYỄN BÁ SƠN	HE186062
6	NGUYỄN PHÚC LÂM	HE195133

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1. Project Introduction

STT	Member	Position	Roles
1	Nguyễn Thị Hải Yến	CEO	• Strategic Commander-in-Chief: Defines the company's vision and long-term objectives. • Resource Allocation: Approves budgets and senior-level hiring decisions. • Company Representative: Acts as the company's spokesperson to partners, investors, and the media. • Corporate Culture Direction: Builds and shapes the company's working culture, product direction, and brand identity. • The CEO communicates the vision and strategic goals to the CMO, CPO, CDO, and CTO. • Works closely with the CMO to ensure marketing activities align with the overall business strategy. • Serves as the final decision gatekeeper for major product, design, and technology decisions.
2	Phạm Thế Sơn	CPO	• Owns the product lifecycle: From ideation → development → launch → continuous improvement. • Defines the product roadmap: Determines features, priorities, and development timelines. • User collaboration: Collects user feedback and continuously optimizes the user experience. • Works closely with the CDO to ensure the product design is visually appealing, user-friendly, and aligned with market expectations.

			• Collaborates with the CMO on product positioning, communication, and go-to-market activities. • Partners with the CTO to translate product vision into scalable and feasible technical solutions.
3	Tăng Lan Anh	CMO	• Develops and executes marketing strategies: Branding, Digital Marketing, and Public Relations. • Customer and market understanding: Conducts research on customer behavior, competitors, and market trends. • Brand and communications management: Takes ownership of brand identity, positioning, and messaging. • Sales enablement: Generates leads, increases brand awareness, and drives revenue through marketing campaigns.
4	Bùi Thị Thùy Dương	CFO	• Manages company-wide financial operations: Budgeting, cost control, cash flow management, and financial reporting. • Financial planning and resource allocation: Determines spending across marketing, R&D, design, and technology. • Ensures long-term financial sustainability: Oversees risk management, financial forecasting, and cost efficiency. • Supports strategic decision-making for the CEO: Provides financial insights on project feasibility and investment priorities.
5	Nguyễn Phúc Lâm	CTO	• Owns technology leadership: Infrastructure, product development, and system architecture.

			• Bridges technology and business: Ensures products are stable, scalable, and aligned with business objectives. • Drives technological innovation: Researches and adopts new technologies to maintain product competitiveness. • Receives requirements from the CPO and translates them into technical solutions. • Supports the CDO by ensuring UX/UI designs are technically feasible across platforms. • Provides analytics and performance data to the CMO to evaluate and optimize marketing effectiveness. • Advises the CEO on technological capabilities and constraints to help realize the company's long-term vision.
6	Nguyễn Bá Sơn	CDO	• Designs user experience and visual identity: UX/UI, product design, and branding. • Owns aesthetics and brand identity: Ensures visual quality and brand consistency across all touchpoints. • Ensures usability and visual coherence: Makes sure products are intuitive, visually appealing, and consistent in design. • Receives the product vision from the CPO and translates it into UI/UX design, packaging, and visual assets. • Supports the CMO in marketing campaigns by delivering creative concepts, visual designs, and branded content. • Collaborates with the CTO to ensure designs are technically feasible and properly implemented across digital products.

1.1 Project Name and Description

Project Name: THE ALMA

Project Description:

THE ALMA is a platform that provides a university identity merchandise ecosystem, enabling students to design and personalize products based on their university's identity.

Instead of traditional fixed uniform designs provided by universities, THE ALMA offers a wide range of product categories, including T-shirts, polo shirts, hoodies, caps, socks, and accessories such as keychains. On each product, students are able to personalize various elements such as their name, academic cohort (e.g., K19, K20), faculty or major, personal slogans, and university-themed stickers or mascots.

At the same time, the platform maintains core elements of university identity, including logos, color schemes adapted from official palettes, and symbolic or cultural attributes associated with each institution. This ensures that every product reflects both institutional identity and individual expression.

THE ALMA operates as a hybrid model combining:

- Consumer products (custom merchandise)
- A technology platform that supports product design and ordering

Through this model, THE ALMA aims to create an "open uniform ecosystem," where students wear university-related products not out of obligation, but as part of their everyday lifestyle.

1.2. Reasons for Choosing This Idea

- **Problem Identification**

Many universities currently offer identity-based products such as polo shirts or jackets. However, these products often present several limitations:

  - Simple and repetitive designs
  - Highly standardized and uniform appearance
  - Limited variety in styles and options
  - Colors that are not suitable for daily wear
  - Lack of personalization

As a result, students tend to wear these products only when required, rather than incorporating them into their daily lives.

Meanwhile, Generation Z students demonstrate strong preferences for:

- Self-expression
- Personalized products
- Items that reflect their sense of belonging to a community

This mismatch between existing offerings and student preferences reveals a clear gap in the market.

- **Market Gap**

The current market includes various services such as:

- Custom printing services
- Class uniform printing workshops
- General merchandise customization platforms

However, these services do not fully address the needs of university students because:

- They do not specifically target the university segment
- They lack structured design systems aligned with university identity
- They do not provide templates based on individual campus branding

Additionally, fashion brands such as DirtyCoins, Degrey, and Coolmate primarily focus on general apparel and do not offer products associated with university identity.

Therefore, there is currently no specialized platform dedicated to personalized university merchandise.

- **Proposed Solution**

THE ALMA addresses this gap by developing a specialized platform:

University Identity Merchandise Platform

The platform enables students to:

- Select product types
- Customize designs within predefined identity frameworks
- Personalize content
- Place orders online

At the same time, the system ensures that all products remain consistent with university identity guidelines.

2. Project Evaluation

- **Innovation**

The core innovation of THE ALMA lies in its **"Open University Merchandise Ecosystem"** model.

Instead of offering fixed uniform designs, the platform provides:

- A wide variety of products
- Flexible design options
- High levels of personalization

This innovation is reflected in three key aspects:

Customization within Identity

Students can personalize products while remaining within the university's identity framework.

Technology-Supported Customization

The web-based platform allows users to:

- Select templates
- Drag and drop design elements
- Add personal details
- Adjust colors within predefined palettes

Community Identity

Products serve not only as fashion items but also as a means for students to:

- Express pride in their university
- Strengthen their sense of belonging

- **Feasibility**

Flexible Production Model

The project adopts a print-on-demand model, which:

- Minimizes inventory risks
- Optimizes operational costs

Clearly Defined Target Market

University students represent a customer segment that is:

- Large in size

- Easily accessible through digital channels
- Highly responsive to personalized products

- **Big Impact**

The project is expected to generate multiple positive impacts:

Social Impact

- Enables students to express personal identity
- Strengthens community connections within universities

Economic Impact

- Unlocks a relatively untapped market segment
- Creates business opportunities in student merchandise

Cultural Impact

- Promotes the development of campus identity culture
- Encourages students to take pride in their institutions

- **Market Size**

The target market consists of university students in Vietnam, with an estimated population of approximately **2.2 million students**.

Based on consumer behavior of Generation Z and benchmarking against similar markets such as class uniforms and community merchandise, it is estimated that **20% to 40% of students** have demand for personalized merchandise. The project adopts a conservative midpoint of **30%** for estimation purposes.

Assuming an average annual spending of **200,000 to 250,000 VND per student**, the market size can be calculated as follows:

- Potential customers: approximately 660,000 students
- Estimated market value: **130 to 170 billion VND per year**

This represents a sufficiently large market with strong growth potential, particularly within the niche of university identity merchandise.

- **Scale-up Ability**

The project demonstrates strong scalability in multiple dimensions:

Expansion across universities

Initially focusing on one institution (e.g., FPT University), the platform can later expand to:

- Other universities
- Academies
- International institutions

Expansion of product categories

Beyond T-shirts, the platform can introduce:

- Hoodies
- Backpacks
- Accessories
- Event-based merchandise

3. Levels of Product/Service

To better understand the value proposition of THE ALMA, the product is analyzed based on the three levels of product: Core Value, Actual Product, and Augmented Product.

- **Core Value**

At its core, THE ALMA delivers both **functional and emotional value** to students. The product is not merely apparel, but a medium for self-expression and identity. Firstly, it allows students to **express both school identity and personal individuality**. Instead of wearing standardized, rigid uniforms, students can represent their school in a way that aligns with their own style preferences. Secondly, the product fosters a **sense of pride and belonging**. By wearing customized school merchandise that feels "true to themselves," students are more likely to feel emotionally connected to their campus community. Finally, THE ALMA aims to **transform the perception of school uniforms**—from something mandatory and restrictive into **voluntary everyday fashion**. This shift is crucial in addressing the common reluctance among students to wear traditional school-branded apparel.

- **Actual Product**

The actual product represents the tangible and visible aspects that customers receive.

THE ALMA offers a **diverse ecosystem of customizable fashion items**, including T-shirts, hoodies, caps, socks, and other accessories. A key feature is the **customization capability**, where customers can choose colors, layouts, logo placements, and add stickers or graphics. For more advanced needs, premium customization options are also available,

allowing for higher-quality and more personalized designs. In terms of design, the products follow **youthful and trendy styles** such as oversized, basic, streetwear, and unisex formats. These styles are carefully selected to match current student fashion preferences, ensuring higher usability in daily life. Regarding quality, THE ALMA emphasizes **high-quality materials and durability**. Products are made from good fabric, with durable printing techniques and well-stitched seams, ensuring both comfort and long-term use. Additionally, packaging is designed to enhance user experience. Each product comes in a **reusable zip bag**, along with a **thank-you card** to create a positive emotional touchpoint, and a **warranty card with contact information** to support customers after purchase.

- **Augmented Product**

The augmented product focuses on additional services and benefits that enhance the overall customer experience.

THE ALMA provides a **flexible delivery and payment system**, including pre-order options to optimize production, on-campus pickup for convenience, and nationwide delivery through e-commerce platforms such as TikTok Shop. In terms of after-sales service, the brand offers **customer-friendly policies**, including easy returns for printing or sizing defects, and exchange options in case of design misalignment. These policies help reduce perceived risk and increase customer trust. Moreover, THE ALMA integrates **digital product support** through a drag-and-drop web interface, allowing users to design their own products بسهولة and intuitively. This feature not only enhances user engagement but also empowers customers to co-create their own fashion items.

4. Market Analysis

4.1. Market Potential

The personalized fashion and custom apparel market is experiencing strong growth, especially as consumers, particularly young people increasingly seek products that both express collective identity and reflect individual personality. Instead of rigid, standardized uniforms, customizable school-identity apparel that combines institutional elements (logo, traditional colors) with personal customization (name, slogan, color combinations, graphic elements) represents a promising and still under-exploited segment in Vietnam.

The demand for personalized products in Vietnam is rising rapidly, contributing to the expansion of the print-on-demand (POD) model in the personalized fashion and accessories sector. This market is valued at approximately USD 1.1 billion in 2024, driven largely by the growth of e-commerce, increasing demand for customization, and advancements in fast digital production technologies.

This forms the foundation for building an **“**open uniform ecosystem**”** product model:

- Preserves school identity (logo, core colors)
- Allows users to customize based on personal preferences (color schemes, illustrations)

This model is particularly suitable for:

- Students
- Clubs, teams, and school events

4.2. Potential of Custom Apparel Products in Vietnam

Personalized handcrafted products (such as custom-printed T-shirts, hoodies, and accessories) are becoming increasingly popular among young consumers due to:

- The desire to express individuality through clothing
- A stronger sense of belonging to a community, class, department, or school
- The development of e-commerce and POD platforms, which enable easy ordering without the need for mass production

Approximately 65% of Vietnamese consumers prefer products with customization elements, reflecting a clear and growing personalization trend in purchasing behavior.

4.3. Market Size

4.3.1. Market Size Analysis Using the TAM – SAM – SOM Model

- **TAM (Total Addressable Market)**

Vietnam has approximately 2.1 million university students. It is estimated that 30% of them are interested in personalized merchandise, resulting in around 630,000 potential customers.

Assuming an average annual spending of 300,000 VND per student, the total market size is calculated as:

TAM ≈ 157.5 billion VND per year

- **SAM (Serviceable Available Market)**

In the initial stage, THE ALMA targets students at major universities and expands nationwide through online platforms.

It is estimated that the business can reach about 70% of the total market:

SAM ≈ 110.25 billion VND per year

- **SOM (Serviceable Obtainable Market)**

The Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM) represents the share of the market that the company can realistically capture in the short term, particularly during the early stages of operation.

For startups entering a competitive market, it is common to achieve a market share of approximately **1–2%** in the initial phase, depending on factors such as brand awareness, marketing effectiveness, and operational capacity.

SOM ≈ 2.2 – 2.4 billion VND per year

4.3.2. Custom Printing and Personalized Manufacturing Market in Vietnam

Beyond the Print-on-Demand (POD) sector, the custom garment printing and personalized product manufacturing market in Vietnam (including various garment printing services) is projected to reach approximately USD 1.15 billion. This growth reflects the expansion of the digital printing industry to meet increasing demand for customized products, driven by several key factors:

- The rapid growth of e-commerce
- Increasing consumer demand for personalization and unique products
- The application of advanced printing technologies that enable single-item production while maintaining high quality and fast processing time

4.4. Market Trends

- **Personalization and Print-on-Demand Trend**

Modern consumers, especially young people, are increasingly looking for products that reflect their individual style rather than standardized and mass-produced items. This shift has led to the strong growth of:

  - Print-on-Demand (POD)
  - Personalized fashion design

In Vietnam, the POD market is considered one of the fastest-growing segments in the online retail industry, driven by the expansion of e-commerce and consumers' desire for unique products.

- **Youth-Oriented Trends in Vietnam**

Vietnamese youth, particularly students and Generation Z, are becoming the primary consumer group in the personalized fashion market.

  - Gen Z strongly expresses personal identity through clothing and accessories.
  - They are willing to pay for products that showcase a pronounced personality and uniqueness.

This trend aligns closely with the project's business model, which combines a sense of community belonging (such as school or class logos) with individual differentiation through customizable design options.

5. KEYS PLAYERS

5.1. List of Leading Business Groups

The market is currently dominated by three main groups of players:

• Traditional Enterprises (B2B): Long-established manufacturers holding direct contracts with school boards. Typical examples include May Phuong Thảo (dominating the Northern market with over 15 showrooms), Hải Anh Uniform (operating three large-scale factories), and Bốn Mùa Uniform.

• E-commerce Retailers: Domestic brands rapidly expanding on platforms such as Shopee and TikTok, including Kookoo, Amazing, and Ardilla. These players mainly focus on basic items with highly competitive pricing.

• Local Brands & Merchandise (B2C): Brands emphasizing student experience, such as The High School Merchandise (THSM), Jadiny (premium segment), and in-house gift shops of international universities (e.g., RMIT, VinUni, Fulbright).

5.2. Market Share of Key Competitors

The Traditional Enterprise group holds the largest market share, accounting for approximately 75% of the total market. This group consists mainly of conventional garment manufacturers and direct contractors. Key players such as May Phuong Thảo and Hải Anh Uniform possess overwhelming advantages through long-term supply contracts with school administrations. Their revenue primarily comes from on-campus sales channels and long-established offline showroom networks.

The fastest-growing segment (approximately 15% market share) belongs to E-commerce retailers. According to Metric data (2025), Shopee currently dominates with over 58% of total online industry revenue. This group attracts a large number of parents and students thanks to convenience and low prices, especially during peak back-to-school seasons.

Finally, Local Brands and Merchandise projects account for around 10% of the market. Although their market share remains modest, this group demonstrates the strongest brand diffusion within Gen Z student communities. Rather than focusing on mass volume, these players target high-end niches in private and international universities (e.g., VinUni, Fulbright, RMIT, VBU), where students have a strong desire to express personal identity through school-related apparel.

5.3. Competitive Capabilities and Limitations of Key Players

A deeper analysis of competitive capabilities reveals significant differences among competitor groups, thereby creating substantial “white spaces” for the project.

For traditional industry leaders, their core competitive advantage lies in economies of scale and extensive distribution networks. However, their inherent weakness stems from rigid, outdated design thinking, with fabric choices prioritizing durability over comfort. As a result, their products remain merely “mandatory attire” rather than evolving into functional fashion items.

In contrast, E-commerce retailers compete primarily on speed and ultra-low pricing. Nevertheless, they face major challenges in brand attachment. Their products are largely mass-produced and lack alignment with the unique spirit of individual schools, leading students to feel disconnected from the uniforms they wear.

Meanwhile, Local Brands and Merchandise players possess superior design capabilities and premium fabric quality (e.g., 100% cotton, French terry). They excel at capturing youth fashion trends but struggle with high price points and scalability issues, as their production processes are often semi-handcrafted and order volumes remain limited.

5.4. Market Gap Analysis – Opportunities for the Project

Based on observations of existing competitors, the project identifies three major unmet gaps in the student uniform market:

First, there is a clear disconnect between uniformity and everyday usability. Most traditional suppliers focus solely on “visual identity” while neglecting “user experience.” This leaves a significant opportunity for lifestyle-oriented products (e.g., oversized hoodies, varsity jackets, local-brand-style T-shirts, hoodies, tote bags, socks, caps) featuring school logos but designed with contemporary aesthetics, enabling students to confidently wear them for part-time work, leisure activities, or extracurricular events.

Second, there is a lack of structured customization services. While Gen Z demonstrates a strong desire for self-expression, large-scale manufacturers often reject small customized orders (e.g., personal names or icons) due to cost constraints. This represents a critical touchpoint for the project to offer controlled customization within a standardized brand identity framework, allowing students to feel that their uniform genuinely belongs to them.

Third, there is a notable absence of a cohesive merchandise ecosystem. Currently, students struggle to find high-quality, well-designed accessory collections (e.g., socks, tote bags, keychains, mouse pads) that are consistently branded and readily available on campus. Developing an “open ecosystem” that extends beyond apparel to everyday student items represents a highly promising niche market.

5.5. Competitive Intensity

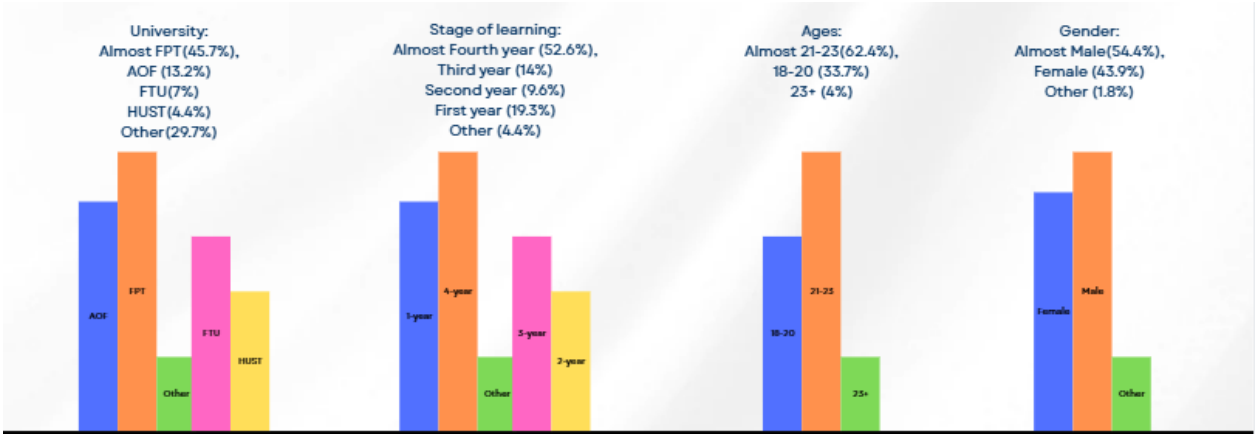
The competitive intensity of the uniform industry is assessed as Medium to High. However, competition is shifting from a price-driven race to a brand value-driven race.

Structurally, the market is no longer dominated solely by local garment workshops; it is increasingly witnessing the entry of fashion brands and local fashion labels. Nevertheless, the biggest barrier for these players is legitimacy and authorization to use school logos and imagery. External brands face significant challenges in gaining student trust without institutional endorsement from the schools themselves.

In terms of market entry potential, the project holds a unique competitive advantage through its "Open Ecosystem" model. Instead of competing directly with traditional manufacturers on price, the project differentiates itself through design experience and personalization rights. At this stage, market entry barriers are no longer capital or machinery, but rather the ability to deeply understand Gen Z psychology and successfully negotiate strategic partnerships with educational institutions. If legal issues related to brand imagery are resolved, the project will establish a strong economic moat that is difficult for purely manufacturing-focused competitors to replicate.

6. Customer's Segmentation Analysis

6.1. Online Survey Analysis

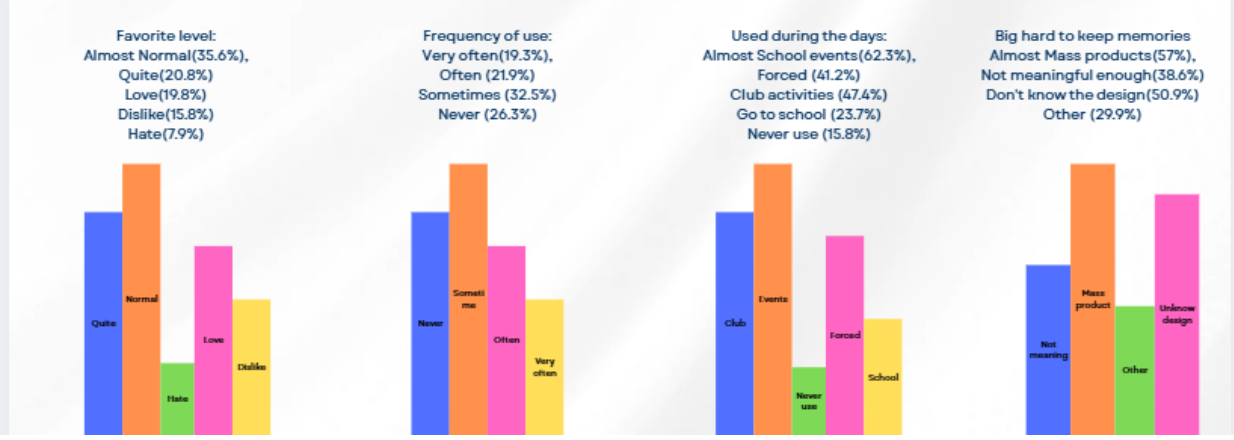


6.1.1. Survey Demographics

The first section shows that we are reaching the right target customer group:

- **Target group:** Mainly students from FPT University (45.7%).
- **Age:** Strongly concentrated in the 21–23 age group (62.4%).
- **Year of study:** The majority are final-year students (52.6%).
- **Gender:** A relatively balanced distribution between males (54.4%) and females (43.9%).

Conclusion: *The statistical results indicate that our primary target customers are final-year university students (mainly from FPT University), aged between 21 and 23, with a fairly balanced gender distribution between male and female users.*



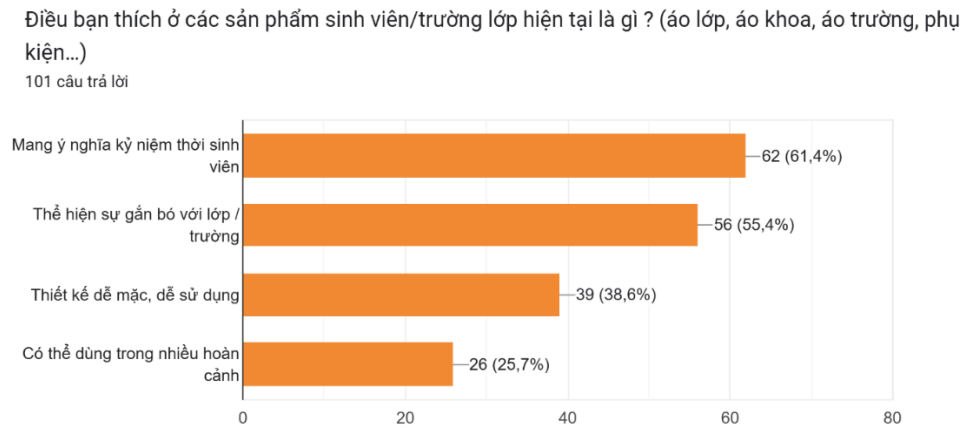
6.1.2. Current Problems & Challenges

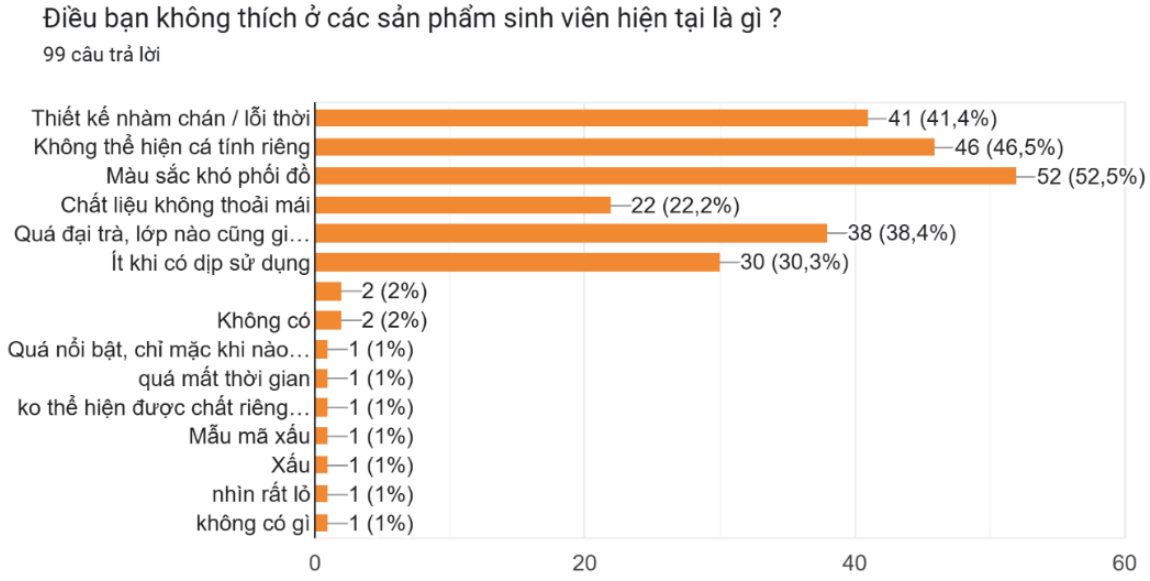
Current users are not highly engaged with souvenir products due to several key reasons:

- **Habits:** They only occasionally keep souvenirs (32.5%) and mainly do so during school or class-related events (62.3%).
- **Product issues:** Existing products are perceived as too generic (57%) and lacking meaningful value (38.6%).
- **Design barriers:** Nearly half of the respondents (50.9%) do not know how to design personalized products by themselves.

Conclusion: *Current users only store souvenirs occasionally, mostly during school-related events or when required. They perceive this activity as ordinary and unexciting because existing products are overly generic and difficult to personalize.*

- **Points of dissatisfaction:** Users are dissatisfied with current products due to boring designs (40.8%) and color schemes that are difficult to match with outfits (52%).

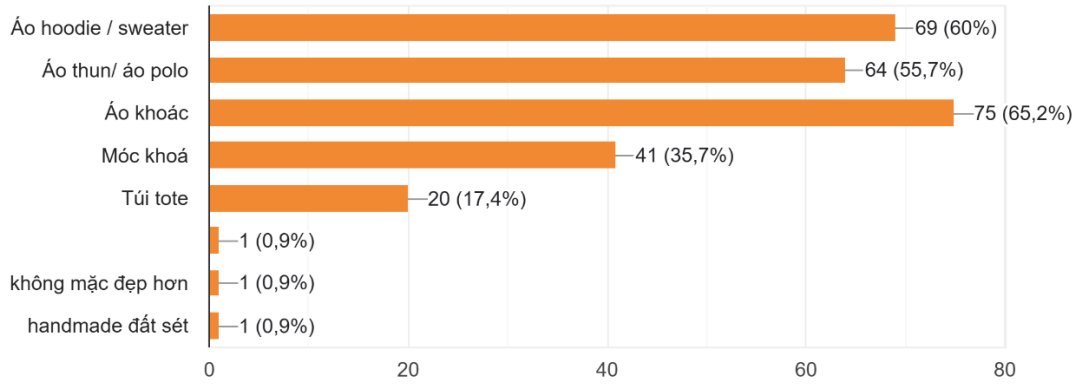




Conclusion: *Students highly value products that carry meaningful memories (62%) and reflect a sense of connection with their school or class (55%). However, they are not satisfied with current products due to color schemes that are difficult to coordinate with outfits (52%), a lack of personal expression (46.9%), and boring designs (40.8%). In addition, most students only use these products during school-related events (62.3%) and face difficulties in designing unique, personalized items on their own (50.9%).*

Bạn muốn thiết kế những sản phẩm nào? (chọn tối đa 3)

115 câu trả lời



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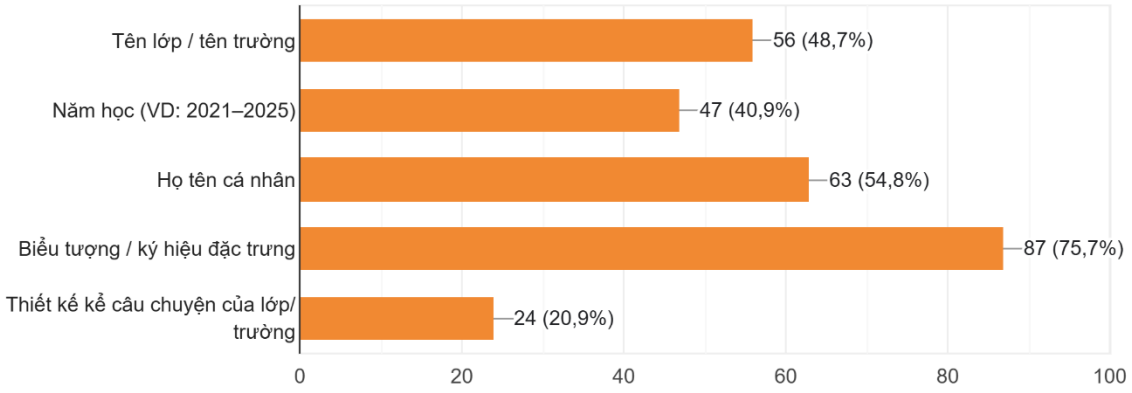
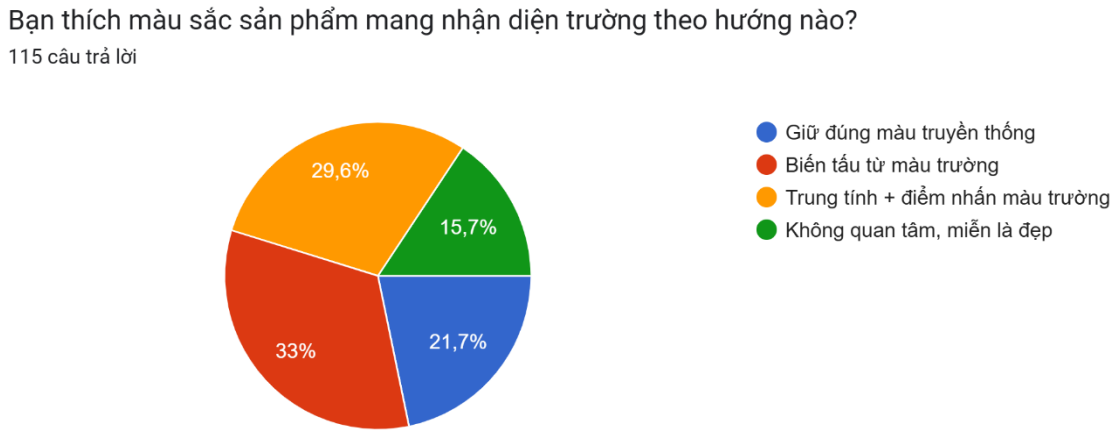




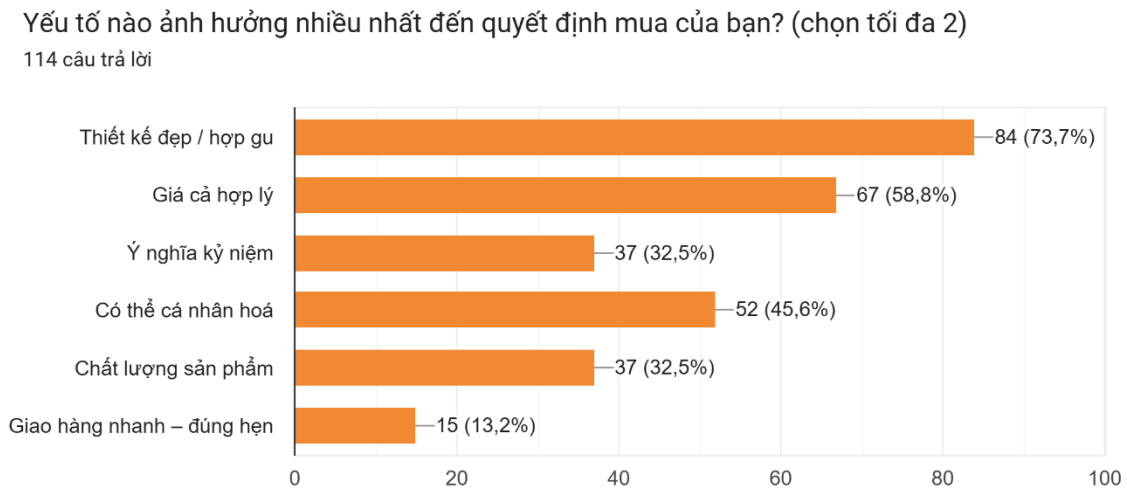
6.1.3. Customer Desires

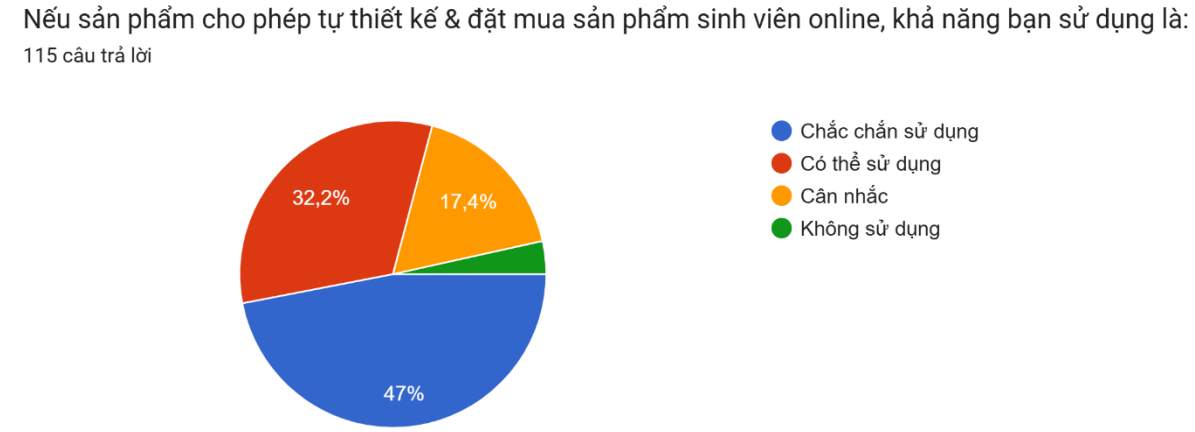
The data reveals a significant opportunity for product personalization:

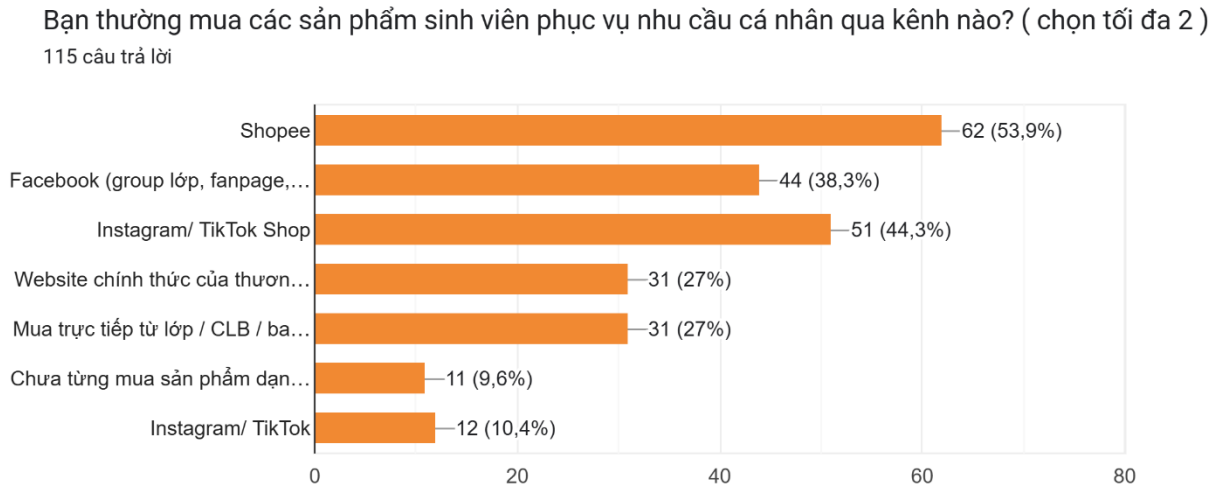
- **Preferred products:** Jackets (64.9%), hoodies/sweaters (59.6%), and T-shirts (56.1%) are the most favored items.
- **Customization elements:** Customers particularly prefer distinctive symbols/icons (75.4%) and personalized name printing (54.4%).
- **Color preferences:** Instead of traditional school colors, users favor modified color variations (33.3%) or neutral tones for everyday wear (28.9%).

Conclusion: *Users demonstrate a strong demand for customized products. The most preferred items are jackets (64.9%) and hoodies/sweaters (59.6%). In terms of design, customers place high importance on attractive designs*

(54.4%) and distinctive symbols or icons (75.4%). Regarding color choices, many users prefer neutral tones with subtle accents (28.9%) or variations based on the school's original colors (33.3%) to achieve a more fashionable look.







6.1.4. Buying Behavior & Market Potential

This section provides a foundation for platform development:

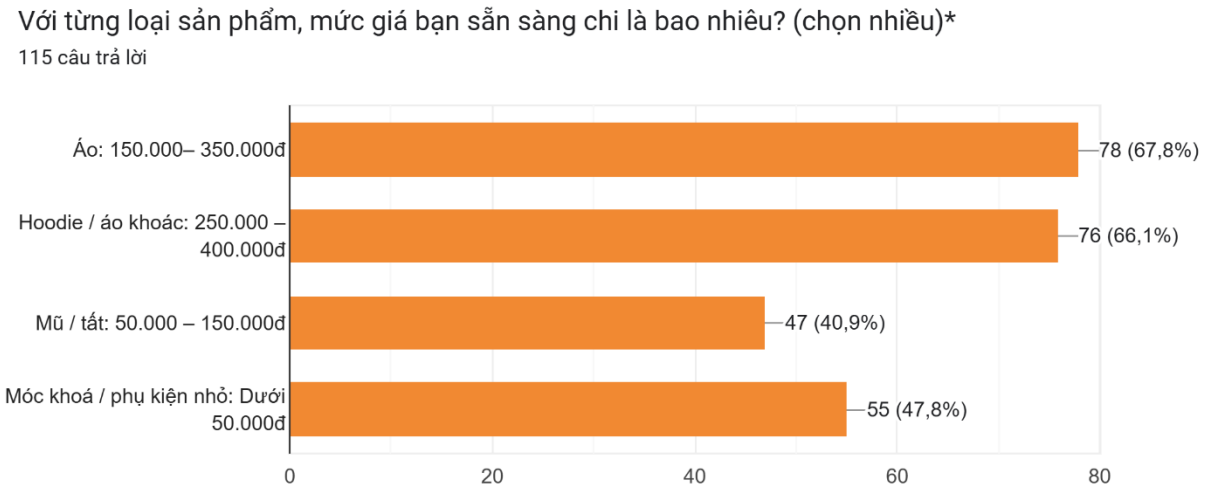
- **Purchase criteria:** Attractive and style-matching design is the most important factor (73.5%), followed by price (58.4%).
- **Shopping channels:** Shopee (53.5%) and TikTok Shop (44.7%) are the primary purchasing platforms.

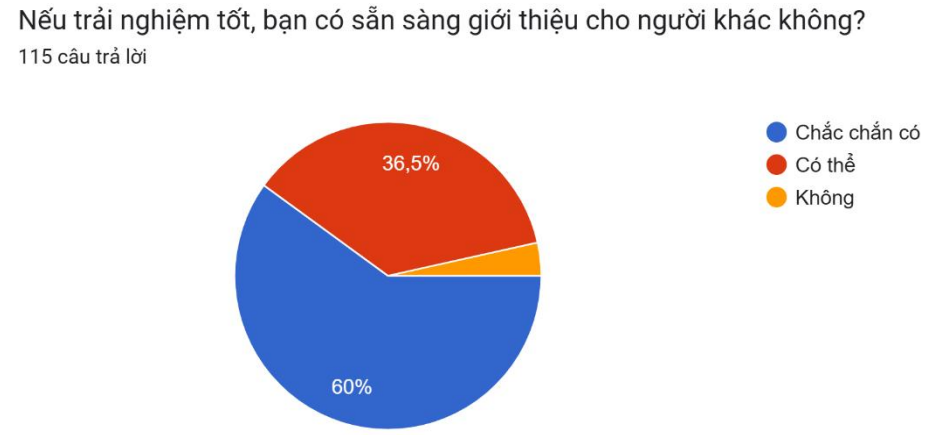
Conclusion: *When purchasing products, students prioritize attractive, style-matching designs (73.5%) and reasonable pricing (58.4%). They mainly shop via Shopee (53.5%) and TikTok Shop (44.7%). Most importantly, nearly 80% of users are willing to use an online platform that allows them to design and order customized products.*

To attract users, the most appealing incentives include free gifts (30.7%), volume-based discounts (29.8%), and free personal name printing (27.2%).

- **Willingness to pay:**
  - 150,000–350,000 VND for T-shirts.
  - 250,000–400,000 VND for jackets/hoodies.

- **Positive feedback:**
  - 79% of users are willing to use an online platform that allows product design and ordering.
  - Nearly 60% would definitely recommend the platform to others if they have a positive experience.





Our project has strong market potential, as 79% of students express interest in using an online platform that allows them to design personalized products. Most users are willing to pay between VND 150,000–350,000 for T-shirts and VND 250,000–400,000 for hoodies or jackets. Their top priorities are attractive design (73.5%) and reasonable pricing (58.4%). With a positive user experience, nearly 60% of users would confidently recommend the service to others.

6.2. Customer Persona

Based on the survey results, our primary target customer segment is university students aged 21 to 23, mainly from FPT University, with a relatively balanced gender distribution. Our representative persona is Nguyễn Khánh Vân, a 22-year-old university student.

Background	**Finance**

• **S**tudent
• Active in school & class events
	• Income mainly from family
	• Willing to pay:
	  ○ T-shirt: 150,000–350,000 VND
	  ○ Hoodie/Jacket: 250,000–400,000 VND

Needs	**Influence Factors**
• Customizable school merchandise • Fashionable designs, easy to wear daily • Meaningful school & class symbols	• Friends & classmates • Social media reviews (TikTok, Instagram)

Hopes and Dreams • Own meaningful university souvenirs • Wear school merchandise confidently outside campus • Strengthen class connection through shared symbols	**Online Behavior** • Shops on Shopee & TikTok Shop • High interest in online customization platforms
Make Their Life Easier • Online platform for self-design & ordering • Ready-made templates & school icons • Group discounts & free name printing	**Worries** and Fears • Designs too generic & boring • Colors hard to style • Hard to self-design unique products

- The core insight here is that students want school merchandise to look like real fashion products, be customizable, and carry genuine sentimental value, rather than being just a compulsory item they have to wear.

7. Competitors' Analysis

	Direct Competitor	**Indirect Competitor (Uniform Factory)**	**Indirect Competitor (Local Brand)**
Competitor	**Gecko.vn, Printub**	**GẤU Uniform, Hải Anh**	**Teelab, Levents**
Product	**Print-on-Demand apparel with free drag-and-drop design tools.**	**Custom bulk uniform production for groups.**	**Ready-to-wear streetwear and seasonal collections.**
Price	**~150,000 - 300,000 VND**	**~100,000 - 200,000 VND (Bulk rate).**	**~250,000 - 400,000 VND**
Place	**Online platforms (Website).**	**Online (Zalo/Fanpage) and physical representative offices.**	**E-commerce (Shopee, TikTok Shop), Websites, Physical Stores.**

Promotion	**Digital Ads (Facebook/Google), SEO.**	**School club sponsorships, offline student events.**	**TikTok KOLs, viral social media campaigns.**
Advantages	**Automated self-service system, no minimum order quantity.**	**Established student network, closed-loop manufacturing.**	**Massive brand awareness, trendy designs, ready-to-ship stock.**
Disadvantages	**Free-for-all design tools cause users to easily distort official school logos.**	**Slow manual design revisions (3-7 days), requires bulk orders.**	**Mass-produced generic items; buyers cannot add personal customization.**

8. SWOT Analysis

Strengths (S)

- Customization Interface: Intuitive drag-and-drop tool allowing real-time personalization without needing professional design software.
- High Personalization & Differentiation: Prevents uniforms from looking "mixed" or generic. Controlled customization keeps the official school identity intact while giving users the freedom to express personal traits.
- Design Automation: Completely removes the dependency on human designers for daily order processing.

Weaknesses (W)

- Material & Production Dependence: Relying heavily on third-party suppliers means any partner mistake directly damages your brand quality.
- Scalability Bottleneck: Production time and logistics could severely lag if the volume of single, highly customized orders spikes unexpectedly.
- Limited Initial Capital: Low initial capital expenditure (CAPEX) makes aggressive mass marketing and rapid scaling difficult.

Opportunities (O)

- Gen Z & Gen Alpha Demand: These generations have a massive, growing need to assert themselves and highly favor personalized products.
- B2B Bulk Orders: High potential to capture orders from university clubs and events (specifically at FPTU and AOF based on survey data).

- Freemium Expansion: Selling premium digital assets (templates, fonts, stickers) provides scalable revenue with near-zero marginal costs.

Threats (T)

- High Competition: The custom T-shirt market is saturated with established players and local brands.
- Low Entry Barrier & Easy to Copy: The basic business model is easy to replicate. Massive POD platforms (like Printub) could quickly copy the "locked print zone" tech feature if they notice this university niche is profitable.
- Price Sensitivity: Students are highly sensitive to price changes, making it difficult to maintain profit margins if supplier costs increase.

9. Customer Journey Map

Stage	**Awareness**	**Consideration**	**Customize**	**Purchase**	**Loyalty**
Time	1–3 days	2–5 days	1–2 days	Same day	1–6 months
Touchpoints	School uniforms TikTok, Shopee Friends' custom merch	Website/App Templates, mockups Reviews, Shopee/TikTok Shop	Design tool Form, color options Logo, name customization	Online store Shopee/TikTok payment Discounts, free name print	Product received Daily use at school Social media
Pain Points	Generic designs Lack of identity	Unsure about price Afraid design is difficult	Afraid design looks bad Hard to choose colors	Concern about quality Mockup vs reality gap	Limited new designs
Emotion	Neutral → Curious	Interested	Excited	Confident	Proud
Customer Actions	Notices boring uniforms Sees better custom merch	Explores website Compares options	Selects form, color Adds logo, name	Applies discount Completes purchase	Wears frequently Shares on social media
Opportunities	Position merch as fashion Show inspiring designs	Provide easy templates Show student examples	Simple drag-and-drop tool Preview mockup	Ensure quality guarantee Offer group discounts	Launch new collections Referral program

The Customer Journey Map illustrates the process that university students go through when discovering, evaluating, customizing, purchasing, and using custom school merchandise. This journey reflects both the functional needs and

emotional experiences of students, highlighting key touchpoints, pain points, and opportunities for improvement. The journey consists of five main stages: Awareness, Consideration, Customize, Purchase, and Loyalty. Unlike traditional merchandise purchasing journeys, this model includes a separate Customize stage, which is critical because personalization is the core value proposition of the product.

In the Awareness stage, which typically lasts between one to three days, students first become aware of custom school merchandise through various touchpoints such as existing school uniforms, social media platforms like TikTok and Facebook, and observing friends wearing customized apparel. At this stage, students are not actively searching for new merchandise, but they begin noticing the limitations of their current uniforms. Many students perceive traditional uniforms as generic, repetitive, and lacking individuality. Seeing visually appealing customized merchandise worn by peers or shared on social media creates curiosity and opens their minds to alternative possibilities. Emotionally, students transition from a neutral state to curiosity. This stage presents an important opportunity for businesses to reposition school merchandise as a form of fashion and identity expression rather than simply a mandatory uniform. By showcasing inspiring designs and emphasizing individuality, brands can effectively capture student attention.

The Consideration stage usually lasts between two to five days and involves active exploration and evaluation. During this stage, students interact with customization platforms such as websites or mobile applications, browse design templates, view mockups, and read reviews from other students. They may also compare options across platforms like Shopee and TikTok Shop to evaluate price, quality, and design flexibility. Students begin imagining how customized merchandise would look on themselves and whether it aligns with their personal style. Emotionally, students feel interested and engaged because customization gives them a sense of control and creative involvement. However, several pain points still exist. Students may feel uncertain about whether the price is affordable or worry that the design process might be complicated. These concerns can create hesitation. Businesses can address these barriers by providing easy-to-use templates, offering design suggestions, and showcasing real examples created by other students to increase confidence and reduce perceived risk.

The Customize stage, which typically lasts one to two days, is the most distinctive and valuable stage in this journey. At this point, students directly interact with customization tools that allow them to select product types such as t-shirts, hoodies, or bomber jackets, choose colors and styles, and add personalized elements such as school logos, names, or slogans. This stage transforms students from passive buyers into active creators. As students design their own merchandise, they develop a strong emotional connection to the product because it reflects their personal identity. Emotionally, students feel excited and empowered, as they are able to create something unique and meaningful. However, some students may still face challenges, such as fear that their design may not look good or difficulty choosing appropriate color combinations. To improve this experience, businesses should provide user-friendly drag-and-drop design tools, real-time previews, and recommended design combinations. These features simplify the process and enhance the user experience.

The Purchase stage typically occurs within the same day once students are satisfied with their design. During this stage, students interact with online stores and payment systems, including Shopee and TikTok Shop. Promotional

incentives such as discounts or free name printing can further encourage purchase decisions. Students finalize their purchase by applying discount codes, confirming their design, and completing payment. Emotionally, students feel confident and satisfied because the product reflects their personal preferences. However, some concerns may still remain, particularly regarding product quality and whether the final product will match the mockup shown online. To address these concerns, businesses should provide quality guarantees, realistic product images, and transparent product descriptions. These measures help build trust and increase purchase conversion rates.

The Loyalty stage extends from one to six months after purchase and focuses on product usage and post-purchase engagement. During this stage, students receive their customized merchandise and begin incorporating it into their daily lives. They wear it to school, club activities, and social events, and often share photos on social media. These behaviors reinforce emotional attachment and strengthen their sense of identity and belonging. Emotionally, students feel proud because the product represents both their school affiliation and their individuality. However, one major pain point at this stage is the limited availability of new designs. Without fresh options, students may lose interest over time. This presents an opportunity for businesses to introduce new collections regularly, offer seasonal designs, and implement referral programs to encourage repeat purchases and brand advocacy. Students who are satisfied with their experience are likely to recommend the product to friends and classmates, becoming organic promoters of the brand.

Overall, the Customer Journey Map highlights that students do not reject school merchandise itself, but rather reject the lack of individuality associated with traditional uniforms. Students are willing to purchase school merchandise when it allows them to express their personal identity while maintaining a connection to their school. Customization plays a critical role in transforming school merchandise from a functional requirement into a meaningful and emotionally valuable product. By addressing key pain points and supporting students throughout each stage of the journey, businesses can increase customer satisfaction, improve conversion rates, and build long-term loyalty. This journey demonstrates that personalization is not only a product feature but also a strategic advantage that enhances both emotional engagement and business performance.

10. Product Market Fit Canvas

- *Customer Segment*

The target customers of the platform are students and Gen Z users, who actively use the internet, social media, and e-commerce platforms. They have a strong demand for ordering customized T-shirts for classes, faculties, student clubs, and campus events. Their core objective is to quickly create T-shirt designs that reflect both personal identity and group spirit in a convenient way, without requiring professional design skills and at a price point suitable for student budgets.

However, traditional class or uniform T-shirts are often standardized, repetitive, and lack creativity, making it difficult to express the unique identity of each group. The conventional ordering process typically involves multiple

intermediaries such as designers and printing workshops, resulting in long waiting times, limited flexibility for revisions, and minimal user control over the final design. At the same time, the growing need for self-expression and community identity among students creates demand for a more flexible, user-driven, and creative solution.

The platform primarily reaches users through its official website, which features an intuitive drag-and-drop design interface. In addition, social media channels such as Facebook and TikTok—especially student groups, class groups, and club communities—play a crucial role in promotion and organic word-of-mouth diffusion. Offline word-of-mouth within student networks also contributes significantly to user acquisition.

In terms of user experience, the platform is designed to be simple and accessible, requiring no prior design skills. Users can easily customize T-shirts using a drag-and-drop interface, preview their designs in real time, and complete ordering and payment entirely online. Overall, the experience is engaging, creative, and encourages collaboration among group members.

- *Product / Service*

Existing alternatives include ordering from traditional printing shops, purchasing pre-printed T-shirts from e-commerce platforms, or hiring freelance designers. However, these options often lack flexibility, involve higher costs, or fail to meet students' personalization needs.

The platform provides a web-based T-shirt design tool that allows users to easily customize colors, logos, names, slogans, and graphics through a drag-and-drop interface. It also offers a library of pre-designed templates tailored for schools, classes, and student clubs. The production process follows a Print-on-Demand model, meaning T-shirts are only produced after an order is placed, which helps optimize costs and minimize inventory risks.

Designed products can be easily shared on social media, enabling organic spread within student communities. The visually engaging and interactive nature of the designs makes the platform particularly suitable for promotion on channels such as TikTok and Facebook.

Key performance metrics are expected to reflect early-stage growth. The website is projected to receive approximately 450+ visits per month, given its initial launch within a limited number of universities. Users are expected to spend around 5–7 minutes per session, as they explore templates, customize designs, and discuss ideas. The bounce rate is estimated to remain below 45%, indicating a relatively engaging and user-friendly experience.

- *Revenue Model & Retention Strategy*

The platform generates revenue primarily through a Print-on-Demand model, where users design, order, and pay based on the quantity of products. In addition, a freemium model allows users to access basic features for free, while advanced customization options—such as premium templates, exclusive graphics, and special fonts—require payment.

The platform also offers group ordering services and small-scale B2B solutions for class uniforms, club apparel, and student events, with volume-based discounts. Furthermore, partnerships with brands or sponsors provide additional revenue opportunities through logo placements on event T-shirts.

To enhance user retention, the platform offers incentives such as discounts for repeat customers and free shipping promotions. New design templates are regularly updated based on seasonal trends and student preferences to maintain freshness and engagement. Additionally, encouraging users to share their designs on social media in exchange for vouchers helps boost engagement while driving organic growth within student communities.

11. Business Model Canvas

- **Key Partners**

The business operates under a **print-on-demand and personalization model**, making strategic partnerships essential for quality control and operational efficiency.

Manufacturing and Printing Workshops

Manufacturing and printing workshops are core partners responsible for producing garments according to official school identity standards while handling customized elements such as names, slogans, and approved color variations. Their flexibility and production capacity directly impact delivery speed and cost control.

Raw Material Suppliers

Raw material suppliers (fabric, ink, embroidery materials) influence product durability, comfort, and brand perception. Since the positioning aims to transform mandatory school apparel into desirable everyday fashion, material quality must meet higher aesthetic and functional standards.

Logistics Providers

Logistics providers ensure timely and accurate delivery. As production occurs per order, reliable shipping performance plays a crucial role in customer satisfaction and brand credibility.

- **Key Activities**

The business model revolves around three main pillars: **design, technology, and operations**.

Template Design

Designing standardized templates aligned with the school's identity (logo, colors, spirit) ensures authenticity and legitimacy. This builds trust among students and maintains institutional consistency.

Platform Development and Operation

Developing and operating the online **drag-and-drop customization platform** represents the core differentiator. It allows students to personalize products within controlled parameters, balancing creativity with brand consistency.

Print-on-Demand Production

Print-on-demand production reduces inventory risk and financial exposure. However, it requires tight coordination between the ordering system and manufacturing partners.

Internal School Marketing

Internal marketing within the school focuses on fostering pride and belonging. Campaigns linked to events, clubs, or academic cohorts stimulate collective purchasing behavior.

Quality Control and Order Fulfillment

Quality control and order fulfillment ensure that each customized product matches the student's specifications and is delivered within the promised timeframe.

- **Key Resources**

The online customization platform is a strategic technological asset. It is not merely a sales tool but the foundation of competitive differentiation, enabling interactive co-creation between the brand and students.

Technological Resources

Personalized printing systems are critical physical resources, allowing individual customization without significantly increasing per-unit costs.

Human Resources

The design and marketing team maintains the brand image, ensures alignment with student trends, and continuously refreshes creative concepts.

Data Resources

The student database within the institution is a valuable data asset, enabling targeted communication, segmented campaigns, and event-based promotions.

- **Value Proposition**

The value proposition operates at three levels: **functional, emotional, and community-based**.

Functional Value

Functionally, the product preserves the official school identity while allowing controlled personalization. Students can express individuality without compromising institutional branding.

Emotional Value

Emotionally, the product transforms “mandatory apparel” into “desirable fashion.” Trend-aligned, versatile designs allow students to wear the product both on campus and in daily life.

Community Value

At the community level, the apparel strengthens school pride and belonging. Limited editions linked to events or clubs enhance group identity and exclusivity.

- **Customer Relationships**

The model primarily relies on a **self-service customization system**, empowering students to actively participate in designing their own apparel. This increases engagement and perceived ownership.

Online support via chat or inbox ensures prompt resolution of issues related to customization, payment, and delivery.

Limited editions tied to events create scarcity and encourage repeat purchases, supporting long-term customer retention rather than one-time transactions.

- **Channels**

The **official customization website** serves as the primary sales channel where personalization, ordering, and payment occur.

Social media platforms such as **Facebook and TikTok** function as awareness and engagement channels. Content focuses on customization experiences, styling inspiration, and event-driven campaigns.

Together, these channels form a **conversion funnel**, where social media generates demand while the website converts interest into sales.

- **Customer Segments**

The primary target segment consists of **full-time undergraduate students (Year 1–4)**. This group values identity expression while maintaining institutional affiliation.

Students involved in **clubs and school events** represent a high-potential segment for bulk or group orders.

In the long term, the model can expand to **alumni**, leveraging nostalgia and institutional pride.

- **Cost Structure**

The largest cost components are **garment production and personalized printing or embroidery**, as each item is processed individually.

Website development and maintenance represent significant initial investments, particularly for advanced **drag-and-drop customization features**.

Marketing expenditures are critical during the early stage to build brand awareness within the institution.

Logistics and order handling costs are variable expenses that increase proportionally with sales volume.

- **Revenue Streams**

The primary revenue source is **customized apparel sales**.

Additional revenue streams include:

  - Accessories such as caps, socks, and keychains
  - Limited-edition collections linked to events

Student bundle offers and group orders help increase the **average order value**.

Premium versions with higher-quality materials create a **higher-margin segment** within the same customer base.

12. Break-even Analysis

12.1. Bill of Materials (BOM) Analysis

Bill of Materials							
No	Product	Chi phí gia công	Chi phí bao bì & Vật tư				Total Cosg per unit
			Túi Zip khóa kéo in Logo	Túi niêm phong (Poly Mailer)	Thẻ cảm ơn & Sticker tặng kèm	Giấy in nhiệt & Băng keo	
1	Áo phông	110,000 VND	2,500 VND	1,500 VND	3,000 VND	1,000 VND	118,000 VND
2	Áo hudy	130,000 VND	2,500 VND	1,500 VND	3,000 VND	1,000 VND	138,000 VND
3	Móc khoá	5,000 VND	0 VND	500 VND	3,000 VND	1,000 VND	9,500 VND
4	Mũ	10,000 VND	1,000 VND	500 VND	3,000 VND	1,000 VND	15,500 VND
5	Tất	5,000 VND	0 VND	500 VND	3,000 VND	1,000 VND	9,500 VND
6	Áo bomber	150,000 VND	2,500 VND	1,500 VND	3,000 VND	1,000 VND	158,000 VND

The Bill of Materials (BOM) presents a detailed breakdown of the total production cost per unit for each product offered in the project. This includes both the manufacturing cost and the packaging and supporting material costs, thereby providing a comprehensive view of the actual cost structure.

Firstly, the manufacturing cost (Chi phí gia công) represents the primary expense incurred in producing each item. This cost varies depending on the complexity and material of the product. For instance, basic items such as keychains and socks have relatively low production costs of 5,000 VND, whereas more sophisticated products like hoodies and bomber jackets require significantly higher costs, ranging from 130,000 VND to 150,000 VND.

Secondly, the packaging and supporting materials (Chi phí bao bì & vật tư) include several standardized components applied across products. These consist of zip-lock bags with printed logos, poly mailers for delivery, thank-you cards combined with stickers, and thermal printing paper with adhesive tape. While these costs are relatively small on an individual basis, they contribute a consistent additional expense of approximately 5,500 to 8,000 VND per unit.

The total cost per unit is calculated by summing the manufacturing cost and all associated packaging costs. For example, the total cost of producing one T-shirt is 118,000 VND, while a hoodie costs 138,000 VND and a bomber jacket reaches 158,000 VND. In contrast, smaller items such as keychains and socks have a total cost of 9,500 VND per unit due to their lower production costs.

12.2. Pricing Strategy Analysis

Price setting			
No	Product	Price	COGS
1	Áo phông	250,000 VND	118,000 VND
2	Áo hoodie	280,000 VND	138,000 VND
3	Móc khoá	15,000 VND	9,500 VND
4	Mũ	45,000 VND	15,500 VND
5	Tất	20,000 VND	9,500 VND
6	Áo bomber	320,000 VND	158,000 VND

The *Price Setting* table presents the project's pricing strategy by comparing the **selling price (Price)** with the **cost of goods sold (COGS)** for each product. This data is derived from the Bill of Materials (BOM) and is designed to ensure that prices remain competitive while maintaining reasonable profit margins.

For the core products, including T-shirts, hoodies, and bomber jackets, the selling prices are set at 250,000 VND, 280,000 VND, and 320,000 VND, respectively, while their corresponding costs are 118,000 VND, 138,000 VND, and 158,000 VND. The significant difference between price and cost indicates the use of a **markup pricing strategy**, resulting in relatively high profit margins. Specifically, the gross profit margins for these items range from approximately 50% to 53%, reflecting strong perceived value and customer willingness to pay for personalized fashion products.

For supplementary products such as keychains, caps, and socks, the prices are set at 15,000 VND, 45,000 VND, and 20,000 VND, respectively. Compared to their costs (9,500 VND, 15,500 VND, and 9,500 VND), these products still generate profit, with caps achieving a relatively higher margin than other low-cost items. This suggests that the pricing strategy has been refined, particularly for caps, to improve overall financial performance.

Overall, the project's pricing approach reflects a combination of:

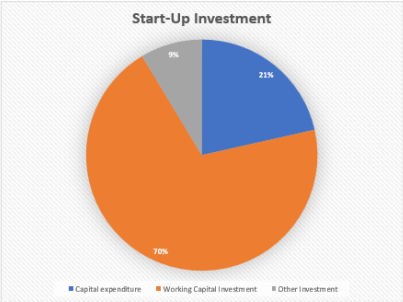
- **Cost-based pricing**, ensuring that all production costs are covered
- **Value-based pricing**, applied to core fashion products
- **Add-on pricing strategy**, used for lower-priced items to encourage additional purchases

This integrated approach not only maximizes profit at the product level but also contributes to increasing the average order value and enhancing overall business performance.

12.3. Start-Up Investment

Start-Up Investment (Unit: VND)							
Capital expenditure (CAPEX)							
No.	Item	Unit	Quantity	Cost/unit	Total	Role	Note
1	**CÔNG NGHỆ VÀ MÁY MÓC**				-		
	Website E-commerce	Item	1	20,000,000	20,000,000	Cửa hàng chính	Giao diện chuẩn SEO, tích hợp thanh toán, quản l
	Máy in đơn hàng	Item	2	1,000,000	2,000,000	In vận đơn	
2	**STUDIO**				-		
	Máy ảnh	Item	1	20,000,000	20,000,000	Chụp ảnh sản ph	Độ phân giải cao, lấy nét tốt, ưu tiên dòng có màu sắc thực
	Đèn Studio (Softbox)	Item	3	2,000,000	6,000,000	Tạo ánh sáng đồ	Ánh sáng trắng (5500K), có thể điều chỉnh độ sáng
	Phông nền (Background)	Set	1	5,000,000	5,000,000	Làm nổi bật màu	Vải hoặc giấy màu trung tính (trắng/xám/be), không nhăn
3	**CHI PHÍ KHÁC**				-		
	Tài sản khác	n/a	1	10,000,000	10,000,000		
Total CAPEX					**63,000,000**		
Working Capital Investment							
No.	Item	Unit	Quantity	Cost/unit	Total		
1	Cash	n/a	1	200,000,000	200,000,000		
2	Supplies	n/a	1	5,000,000	5,000,000		
Total Working Capital Investment					**205,000,000**		
Other Investment							
No.	Item	Unit	Quantity	Cost/unit	Total		
1	Legal Procedure						Source
	Trademark registration	Item	1	1,270,000	1,270,000		
	Tax code fee	Item	1	1,200,000	1,200,000		
	Intellectual property registration	Item	1	1,080,000	1,080,000		
	Business registration	Year	1	2,000,000	2,000,000		
	Digital signature	Item	1	1,067,000	1,067,000		
	Company seal & seal registration	Item	1	450,000	450,000		
	Public information disclosure fee on national por	Item	1	200,000	200,000		
	Invoice issuance fee	Year	1	5,000,000	5,000,000		
2	The brand identity	n/a	1	5,000,000	5,000,000		
3	Rent deposit	Month	1	8,000,000	8,000,000		TIKTAK COWORKING SPACEHotline: 0898.580.666Email: booking@tiktak.com.vnWebsite: https://tiktak.com.vnĐịa chỉ:TIKTAK 1
Total Other Investment					**25,267,000**		

Start-Up Investment (Unit: VND)	
Capital expenditure	63,000,000
Working Capital Investment	205,000,000
Other Investment	25,267,000
Total Investment	**293,267,000**



The *Start-Up Investment* table outlines the total initial capital required to launch the project, categorized into three main components: **Capital Expenditure (CAPEX)**, **Working Capital Investment**, and **Other Investments**. The total estimated investment amounts to **293,267,000 VND**.

Firstly, **Capital Expenditure (CAPEX)** accounts for **63,000,000 VND**, representing investments in long-term assets and infrastructure necessary for business operations. This includes the development of an e-commerce website, printing equipment, and a studio setup for product photography. The studio investment, comprising a camera, softbox lighting, and background setup, plays a crucial role in ensuring high-quality product images, which is essential for online retail performance. Overall, CAPEX constitutes approximately **21%** of the total investment.

Secondly, the largest portion of the budget is allocated to **Working Capital Investment**, totaling **205,000,000 VND**, or roughly **70%** of the total investment. This includes cash reserves and operational supplies required to maintain day-to-day business activities. The high proportion of working capital indicates a strong emphasis on liquidity and operational stability, ensuring that the business can sustain its operations during the initial stages before generating stable revenue.

Lastly, **Other Investments** amount to **25,267,000 VND**, accounting for about **9%** of the total budget. This category includes legal and administrative expenses such as trademark registration, tax code registration, intellectual property registration, and business licensing. In addition, it covers brand identity development and rental deposits. These expenses are essential for establishing a legally compliant and professionally branded business.

In conclusion, the investment structure demonstrates a well-balanced allocation of resources, with a strong focus on operational readiness and sustainability. The significant allocation to working capital reflects a risk-aware strategy, ensuring that the business maintains sufficient liquidity to navigate the early stages of operation while gradually building revenue streams.

12.4. Fixed Cost Justification

Operating Expense (Unit: VND)									
		Year 1		Year 2		Year 3		Year 4	
No	Expense	Expenses per month	Expenses per Year	Expenses per month	Total Expenses per Year	Expenses per month	Total Expenses per Year	Expenses per month	Total Expenses per Year
1	Rental Expense	8,000,000	96,000,000	8,000,000	96,000,000	8,800,000	105,600,000	8,800,000	105,600,000
2	Salary Expenses	43,141,567	517,698,800	54,764,467	657,173,600	71,258,217	855,098,600	95,409,867	1,144,918,400
3	Hosting	187,500	2,250,000	262,500	3,150,000	337,500	4,050,000	415,500	4,986,000
4	Server	120,900	1,450,800	150,900	1,810,800	226,900	2,722,800	453,900	5,446,800
5	Supplies Expenses	1,500,000	18,000,000	1,620,000	19,440,000	1,701,000	20,412,000	1,786,050	21,432,600
6	Business-license tax		2,000,000		2,000,000		2,000,000		2,000,000
	Total Fixed cost	***52,949,967***	***637,399,600***	***64,797,867***	***779,574,400***	***82,323,617***	***989,883,400***	***106,865,317***	***1,284,383,800***
1	COGS	101,222,000	1,214,664,000	125,963,000	1,511,556,000	144,698,500	1,736,382,000	173,477,500	2,081,730,000
2	Marketing expense	31,893,000	382,716,000	39,687,750	476,253,000	36,474,000	437,688,000	43,729,200	524,750,400
3	Other expense	1,200,000	14,400,000	1,260,000	15,120,000	1,323,000	15,876,000	1,389,150	16,669,800
	Total Variable cost	***134,315,000***	***1,611,780,000***	***166,910,750***	***2,002,929,000***	***182,495,500***	***2,189,946,000***	***218,595,850***	***2,623,150,200***

Fixed costs are determined based on the operational requirements of the business and are relatively stable regardless of sales volume, with gradual increases reflecting business expansion.

Firstly, **rental expense** is calculated based on the assumption that the business operates in a small office or co-working space, with an estimated cost of 8,000,000 VND per month in the initial years. This results in an annual expense of 96,000,000 VND. From Year 3 onwards, the rental cost increases by approximately 10% to account for either expansion or rising market rental rates.

Secondly, **salary expenses** constitute the largest component of fixed costs and are estimated based on the planned number of employees and average salary levels. In Year 1, the team is assumed to consist of approximately 6 members with an average salary of 5 to 6 million VND per month, resulting in a total monthly payroll of around 43 million VND. In subsequent years, salary expenses increase significantly due to both team expansion and salary adjustments, reaching over 95 million VND per month by Year 4. This reflects the project's strategy to scale its workforce in line with business growth.

In addition, **hosting and server costs** are calculated based on the expected growth in website traffic and data storage requirements. As the business expands and online operations intensify, these costs increase gradually each year.

Similarly, **supplies expenses**, which include packaging support materials and office supplies, are assumed to increase moderately (approximately 5–10% annually) in line with operational scale. Meanwhile, **business license tax** remains constant at 2,000,000 VND per year, as it is a fixed regulatory expense.

12.5. Variable Cost Justification

Variable costs are directly linked to the level of business activity and are primarily driven by projected sales volume.

The most significant component is **Cost of Goods Sold (COGS)**, which is calculated using the formula:

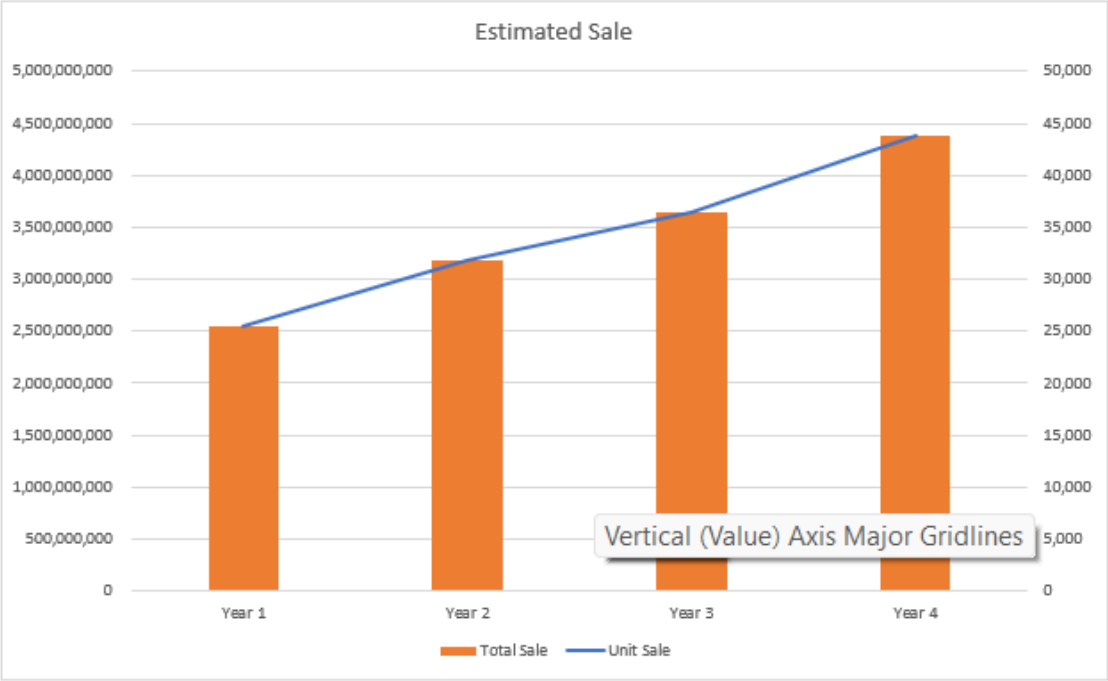
COGS=Quantity Sold×Cost per UnitCOGS = Quantity\ Sold \times Cost\ per\ UnitCOGS=Quantity Sold×Cost per Unit

The cost per unit is derived from the Bill of Materials (BOM), while the quantity sold is estimated based on sales forecasts. For instance, in Year 1, total COGS is approximately 1.21 billion VND, which implies an estimated sales volume of around 12,000 units, assuming an average unit cost of 100,000 VND. By Year 4, COGS increases to over 2.08 billion VND, corresponding to an estimated sales volume of approximately 20,000 units. This reflects an assumed annual growth rate in sales volume of around 15–20%.

Secondly, **marketing expenses** are determined based on the company's growth strategy rather than being fixed. The project allocates higher marketing budgets in expansion phases (e.g., Year 2 and Year 4) to acquire customers and build brand awareness, while optimizing spending in intermediate periods (e.g., Year 3).

Lastly, **other expenses** include logistics, product returns, and miscellaneous operational costs. These are assumed to increase gradually in proportion to sales volume, reflecting the additional costs incurred as the business scales.

12.6.Justification of Estimated Sales Figures



The *Estimated Sale* table presents the projected unit sales, total revenue, and cost of goods sold (COGS) over a four-year period. These figures are not randomly generated but are derived from a structured set of assumptions, including **market size, product mix, and operational capacity**.

- **Basis for Estimating Unit Sales**

The estimated monthly sales volume is determined based on two key factors.

Firstly, regarding **market size**, the project targets university students. However, not all potential customers will make a purchase. Therefore, a conversion-based approach is applied, assuming that only a small proportion of the target market will become actual buyers. Based on this, the initial sales volume is estimated at approximately **2,127 units per month**, equivalent to **25,524 units in the first year**. This is considered a conservative estimate suitable for a startup.

Secondly, in terms of **operational capacity**, this sales volume corresponds to approximately **70 orders per day**, which aligns with the processing capability of a small team in the early stage. This ensures that the forecast is not only market-driven but also operationally feasible.

In subsequent years, sales volume is projected to grow at an annual rate of **15–20%**, reaching **43,752 units by Year 4**. This growth reflects improvements in marketing effectiveness, brand awareness, and customer base expansion.

- **Basis for Product Mix**

The distribution of sales across different product categories is based on consumer behavior.

Core products such as **T-shirts** and **hoodies** account for a significant share due to their high demand. Meanwhile, low-priced items such as **keychains** tend to be purchased in larger quantities, contributing to higher transaction volume.

On the other hand, premium products such as **bomber jackets** have lower sales volume but contribute significantly to total revenue. Products like **caps and socks** serve as complementary items, supporting upselling strategies.

This product mix enables the business to balance **sales volume** and **order value**.

- **Revenue Estimation**

Revenue is calculated using the formula:

Revenue=Unit Sales×PriceRevenue = Unit\ Sales \times PriceRevenue=Unit Sales×Price

Product prices are assumed to remain stable throughout the forecast period to maintain market competitiveness. Therefore, revenue growth is primarily driven by increased sales volume.

Total revenue increases from approximately **VND 2.55 billion in Year 1** to **VND 4.37 billion in Year 4**, reflecting a strategy focused on market expansion rather than price increases.

- **COGS Estimation**

COGS is calculated as follows:

COGS= Unit Sales × Cost per

The cost per unit is derived from the Bill of Materials (BOM), which includes production and packaging costs.

Since unit costs are assumed to remain relatively stable, COGS increases proportionally with sales volume. Specifically, COGS rises from approximately **VND 1.2 billion in Year 1** to over **VND 2.08 billion in Year 4**, reflecting the nature of variable costs.

- **Overall Evaluation**

Overall, the figures in the table are developed based on a logical and consistent framework, demonstrating a clear relationship between sales volume, revenue, and costs.

The projected growth rate is moderate and realistic, aligning with the operational capacity of the business. However, as these figures are based on assumptions, they should be continuously monitored and adjusted based on actual performance.

12.7. Estimated Cash Flow

Estimated Cash Flow (Unit: VND)					
	0	2026	2027	2028	2029
Sales		**2,551,440,000**	**3,175,020,000**	**3,647,400,000**	**4,372,920,000**
Fixed Cost		**- 637,399,600**	**- 779,574,400**	**- 989,883,400**	**- 1,284,383,800**
Variable Cost		**- 1,611,780,000**	**- 2,002,929,000**	**- 2,189,946,000**	**- 2,623,150,200**
EBITDA		**302,260,400**	**392,516,600**	**467,570,600**	**465,386,000**
Depreciation and allocation expenses		- 24,583,333	- 23,833,333	- 14,583,333	-
EBIT = EBITDA - D&A		**277,677,067**	**368,683,267**	**452,987,267**	**465,386,000**
Corporate income tax		- 55,535,413	- 73,736,653	- 90,597,453	- 93,077,200
Net operating profit after tax		**222,141,653**	**294,946,613**	**362,389,813**	**372,308,800**
Plus: Depreciation and allocation expenses		24,583,333	23,833,333	14,583,333	-
Cash Flow From Operations		**246,724,987**	**318,779,947**	**376,973,147**	**372,308,800**
Less: Capital Expenditure	- 63,000,000				
Less: Change in Working capital	- 205,000,000				
Less: Other Investment	- 25,267,000				
Free Cash Flow	**- 293,267,000**	**246,724,987**	**318,779,947**	**376,973,147**	**372,308,800**
Remind cost	- 293,267,000	- 46,542,013	272,237,933	649,211,080	1,021,519,880
PAYBACK PERIOD (year)	**1.15**				

The *Estimated Cash Flow* table presents the projected cash flows of the project from 2026 to 2029, aiming to evaluate profitability and investment recovery. The figures are derived from the **sales forecast, cost structure, and initial investment plan**.

- **Revenue (Sales)**

Revenue is obtained from the *Estimated Sale* table:

  - 2026: VND 2.55 billion
  - 2029: VND 4.37 billion

Growth is driven by increasing sales volume while prices remain stable.

- **Costs**

Fixed Costs

Include rent, salaries, and operational expenses, increasing with business expansion.

Variable Costs

Primarily COGS, calculated as:

COGS=Unit Sales×Cost per UnitCOGS

- **Profitability (EBITDA & EBIT)**

EBITDA

EBITDA=Revenue−FixedCost−VariableCost
Indicates strong operational performance.

EBIT

EBIT=EBITDA−Depreciation EBIT
Depreciation is allocated from initial capital expenditures.

- **Net Operating Profit After Tax**

Corporate income tax is assumed at **20% of EBIT**.

Profit increases steadily, reflecting business growth.

- **Cash Flow from Operations**

CFO= Net Profit + Depreciation
Depreciation is added back as a non-cash expense.

- **Free Cash Flow**

Initial investment (Year 0):

  - CAPEX: VND 63 million
  - Working Capital: VND 205 million
  - Other Investment: VND 25.3 million

Total: **VND 293.3 million**

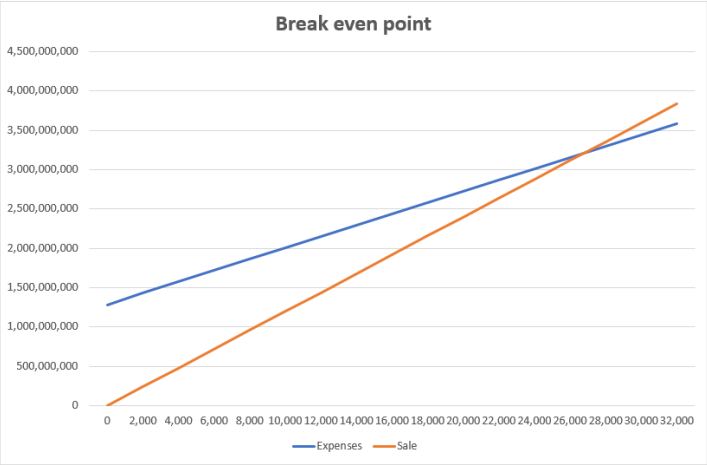
Free cash flow remains positive from Year 1 onward.

Payback Period

The project recovers its initial investment in approximately: **1.15 years**

12.8. Break-even Point Analysis

Break even point	
Total Unit Sale	36,480
Total Sales	4,372,920,000
Total Fixed Cost	1,284,383,800
Total Variable Cost	2,623,150,200
Average price per unit	119,872
Average Variable Cost per unit	71,907
Break Even Point	26,777



The break-even analysis is conducted to determine the minimum level of sales required to cover total costs, thereby evaluating the financial viability and risk level of the project.

- **Input Data**

The figures are based on Year 4 (steady-state operation):

  - **Total unit sales:** 36,480 units
  - **Total revenue:** VND 4,372,920,000
  - **Total fixed cost:** VND 1,284,383,800

- **Total variable cost:** VND 2,623,150,200

- Average Price and Cost per Unit

Average selling price

=RevenueUnits=119,872 VND= \frac{Revenue}{Units} = 119,872\ VND=UnitsRevenue=119,872 VND

Average variable cost

=Variable CostUnits=71,907 VND= \frac{Variable\ Cost}{Units} = 71,907\ VND=UnitsVariable Cost=71,907 VND

- **Break-even Point Calculation**

BEP=Fixed CostPrice−Variable Cost=1,284,383,800119,872−71,907≈26,777 unitsBEP = \frac{Fixed\ Cost}{Price - Variable\ Cost} = \frac{1,284,383,800}{119,872 - 71,907} \approx 26,777\ unitsBEP=Price−Variable CostFixed Cost =119,872−71,9071,284,383,800≈26,777 units The company must sell **26,777 units** to break even.

- **Break-even Chart Analysis**

The chart illustrates:

  - Revenue line
  - Total cost line

Their intersection represents the break-even point, beyond which the company generates profit.

- **Financial Safety Analysis**

  - Expected sales: 36,480 units
  - Break-even point: 26,777 units

Margin of Safety:≈26.6%\approx 26.6\%≈26.6%

This indicates a relatively strong safety buffer.

- **Conclusion**

The break-even analysis shows that:

  - The project can achieve break-even at a reasonable sales level
  - Expected sales significantly exceed the break-even point

- The business has strong profitability potential and low financial risk

13. INVESTOR EVALUATION CRITERIA

This section evaluates THE ALMA project based on key criteria commonly used by investors in decision-making, including management capability, business feasibility, product differentiation, market attractiveness, and financial potential.

- **Management Team Criteria**

Personality and Skills

The founding team demonstrates strong communication, collaboration, and problem-solving skills, which are essential for executing a platform-based business model. As university students, the team possesses a deep understanding of the target market's behavior, preferences, and consumption patterns.

In addition, the team shows adaptability and a willingness to learn, particularly in areas such as digital marketing, product design, and customer experience. These qualities are critical for early-stage startups operating in dynamic environments.

- **Business & Deal Criteria**

Amount of Money Requested

THE ALMA is currently in the early development stage and requires an initial investment to support platform development, marketing activities, and initial operations.

The estimated funding requirement ranges from **200 to 300 million VND**, allocated as follows:

- Platform development and UI/UX design
- Marketing and customer acquisition
- Supplier coordination and production setup
- Operational costs in the early stage

- **Product / Service Criteria**

Characteristics

THE ALMA provides customizable university merchandise through a digital platform that integrates product selection, design, and ordering into a seamless experience.

Identification

The product is strongly tied to university identity, incorporating official colors, logos, and symbolic elements while allowing personal customization.

Differentiation

Unlike traditional uniform products or general custom printing services, THE ALMA differentiates itself by:

- Focusing specifically on university students
- Offering structured customization within identity frameworks
- Combining technology with merchandise production

- Financial Criteria

Time to Break-even & Payback

Due to the adoption of a print-on-demand model, THE ALMA minimizes fixed costs and inventory risks, which shortens the path to break-even.

The project is expected to reach break-even within **12 to 18 months**, depending on:

- Customer acquisition rate
- Marketing efficiency
- Order volume growth

- Market Criteria

Potential & Growth

The target market consists of approximately **2.2 million university students in Vietnam**, with an estimated **20%–40% demand** for personalized merchandise.

This results in a potential market size of **130–170 billion VND annually**, indicating strong growth opportunities, especially as personalization trends continue to rise among Generation Z consumers.

Additionally, the market remains underdeveloped in terms of structured university identity merchandise platforms, providing a first-mover advantage for THE ALMA.

- **Investor Criteria**

Emotional, Intrinsic Factors, Social Motivation & Relation

THE ALMA is not only a commercial project but also carries meaningful social and cultural value.

From an investor perspective, the project:

- Supports youth creativity and self-expression
- Enhances student engagement and community identity

Contributes to the development of campus culture